

CONFIRMED FLIGHT EDITION

Taiwan in 10 Days

Ahmedabad to Taiwan | 1-10 November 2026 | 9 nights

ARRIVAL	DEPARTURE
Sunday, 1 November 11:55 local time Taoyuan Airport assumed	Tuesday, 10 November 13:10 local time Leave central Taipei about 08:30

TAIPEI	TAICHUNG	ALISHAN	TAINAN	TAIPEI
4 nights	1 night	1 night	2 nights	1 night

THE FINAL ROUTE

One Alishan night preserves the full Chiayi-Fenghu-Alishan mainline railway and sunrise option. Kaohsiung is a day stop with luggage stored at Zuoying, removing a hotel check-in. Shopping is folded into existing sightseeing routes rather than using a separate day.

TRAVEL STYLE	MOST IMPORTANT BOOKING
Public transport first, one shared north-coast tour, short taxis only where they save meaningful time.	Set an alarm for 23 October at 03:30 India time for the Alishan mainline and sunrise trains.
HOTEL CHECK-INS	GROUND BUDGET
Taipei, Taichung, Alishan, Tainan, then Taipei again. No Kaohsiung hotel.	Approximately INR 1.9-2.75 lakh for two, excluding booked flights, visa and discretionary shopping.

Assumption

The airport is assumed to be Taoyuan International Airport. Reconfirm terminal details from the airline booking. Timetables and prices remain subject to operator changes.

1. Day-wise outline and highlights

The plan is active but avoids two major inefficiencies: a second Alishan hotel night and a separate Kaohsiung check-in.

Day	Date / sleep	Plan	Highlight	Pace
1	Sun 1 Nov Taipei	Arrive 11:55; hotel; Longshan/Bopiliao if energetic; Ximending	Low-pressure arrival	Light
2	Mon 2 Nov Taipei	CKS Memorial, Dihua, Xinyi, Taipei 101, Elephant Mountain	Skyline + main shopping	Active
3	Tue 3 Nov Taipei	Shared Yehliu-Shifen-Jiufen tour	North-coast loop	Active
4	Wed 4 Nov Taipei	Beitou, Tamsui sunset, optional Eslite Nanxi	Thermal + riverside	Light
5	Thu 5 Nov Taichung	HSR, hotel drop, theater, optional Rainbow Village	Architecture + city	Active
6	Fri 6 Nov Alishan	TRA to Chiayi; full forest railway via Fenqihu	Mainline railway	Transfer
7	Sat 7 Nov Tainan	Sunrise, forest circuit, 14:40 bus, HSR to Tainan	Cypress forest	Active
8	Sun 8 Nov Tainan	Historic core, Hayashi shopping, Anping	Best heritage day	Active
9	Mon 9 Nov Taipei	Zuoying lockers; Pier-2, Hamasen, Cijin; HSR north	Kaohsiung harbor	Active
10	Tue 10 Nov	Airport MRT; 13:10 flight	Protected departure	Light

What was removed

Sun Moon Lake, Okinawa, a second Alishan night and the Kaohsiung overnight are not in this version. Elephant Mountain appears once. The National Palace Museum is omitted because Monday does not fit cleanly and the shortened route already has strong cultural days.

2. Booking calendar

Book the fragile mountain components first. Urban transit, general admissions and station lockers do not require advance purchase.

Item	When to act	Priority	Action
All hotels	Now	CRITICAL	Use refundable rates. Alishan must be inside the National Forest Recreation Area.
Visa / TAC eligibility	Now	CRITICAL	Check both travelers separately; complete the appropriate process.
Taipei-Taichung HSR	Around 8 Oct	YES	Reserve an early 5 Nov train; choose seats together.
Taichung-Chiayi TRA	Around 9 Oct	YES	Choose a 6 Nov train arriving at Chiayi by 09:00-09:15.
Chiayi-Alishan mainline	23 Oct, 03:30 IST	CRITICAL	Book the 10:00 train for 6 Nov as soon as inventory opens.
Zhushan sunrise train	23 Oct, 03:30 IST	YES	Book for 7 Nov; exact departure is posted the previous afternoon.
Alishan-HSR Chiayi bus	When inventory opens	YES	Target 14:40 on 7 Nov; keep 16:40 only as backup.
Chiayi-Tainan HSR	Around 10 Oct	YES	Choose a changeable train after the scheduled bus arrival.
Tainan-Xinzuoying TRA	Same day or 28 days	OPTIONAL	A frequent train is likely; reserve only if a limited express best fits.
Zuoying-Taipei HSR	Around 12 Oct	YES	Book about 18:00 for comfort or 19:30 after Cijin sunset.
North-coast shared tour	1-3 weeks before	YES	Verify pickup, English support and whether Yehliu entry is included.
Taipei 101	Same day	OPTIONAL	Book after checking visibility unless a fixed sunset slot matters.
Beitou private bath	3-7 days before	OPTIONAL	Reserve only if you want a private couple room.
TWAC	Within 7 days of arrival	YES	Complete the free official Taiwan Arrival Card online.

Alishan release rule

Online sales open at 06:00 Taiwan time. The Friday rule allows booking the Friday, Saturday and Sunday two weeks later, so both the 6 November mainline and 7 November sunrise train should become bookable on Friday 23 October at 03:30 India time. Recheck the official site one week earlier.

3. Detailed itinerary

Daily estimates include local/intercity transport, ordinary admissions and food for two, but exclude hotels, booked flights and discretionary shopping.

DAY 1 | SUN 1 NOV

LIGHT

Arrival and an easy Ximending evening

Overnight: Taipei | Pace: Light

- Land at Taoyuan at 11:55. Allow 60-90 minutes for immigration, luggage and connectivity.
- Take the Airport MRT Express to Taipei Main, then MRT or a short taxi to a Ximending/Taipei Main hotel. A realistic hotel arrival is 14:30-15:00.
- After rest, visit Longshan Temple and Bopiliao only if energy is good. Walk Ximending for dinner and light shopping.

HOW TO MOVE	BAGS
Airport MRT Express, then Taipei MRT or a short metered taxi for the final luggage leg.	With you until hotel check-in. Choose a staffed hotel with luggage storage.
DAY COST FOR TWO	BOOKING
NT\$1,000-1,700 (about INR 3,100-5,300), excluding hotel and booked flight.	Airport MRT and EasyCard are walk-up. TWAC must already be complete.

Vegetarian food

Mi Shan near Taipei Main for vegetarian rice/noodles, or a convenient Vege Creek branch. Allow NT\$150-300 per person.

Shopping on this day

Use Ximending for cosmetics, casual clothes, character goods, phone accessories and forgotten essentials. Browse rather than buying bulky items on the first night.

DECISION NOTE

Do not schedule Taipei 101 or another timed attraction. Flight delays and immigration are unpredictable.

DAY 2 | MON 2 NOV

ACTIVE

Historic core, shopping, skyline and Elephant Mountain

Overnight: Taipei | Pace: Active

- Morning: Chiang Kai-shek Memorial Hall, then Yongkang or the historic center.
- Late morning/early afternoon: Dihua Street for tea, dried fruit, fabrics and local gifts. Allow 60-90 minutes.
- Late afternoon: Xinyi district and Taipei 101 only if visibility is worthwhile. Continue to Elephant Mountain for blue-hour views, then shop or dine in Xinyi.

HOW TO MOVE	BAGS
MRT and walking. Walk from Xiangshan MRT to Elephant Mountain; use the first major viewpoint if tired.	Leave all luggage at the Taipei hotel.
DAY COST FOR TWO	BOOKING
NT\$2,700-3,500 with Taipei 101; NT\$1,500-2,300 without it. Shopping excluded.	Taipei 101 can be booked same day; Dihua and Xinyi shops are walk-in.

Vegetarian food

Fruitful Food for a vegetarian buffet (reserve at peak time) or Little Tree Food for a nicer dinner. Budget NT\$350-900 per person.

Shopping on this day

Dihua is the main local-gift stop. Xinyi is better for brands, cosmetics and department stores, generally open into the evening.

DECISION NOTE

Elephant Mountain appears only on this day. Do not repeat it later.

DAY 3 | TUE 3 NOV

ACTIVE

Yehliu, Shifen and Jiufen by shared tour

Overnight: Taipei | Pace: Active

- Join a central Taipei shared coach/minibus. The usual loop includes Yehliu Geopark, Shifen Waterfall and Old Street, then Jiufen.
- One shared sky lantern is enough if you want the activity. In Jiufen, prioritize the lanes, tea-house views and atmosphere.
- Return to Taipei in the evening and dine near the drop-off point.

HOW TO MOVE	BAGS
Shared tour is best value for two. A private car is unnecessary unless you want custom pacing or a much later Jiufen departure.	Leave luggage at the hotel. Carry water, rain shells and a light layer.
DAY COST FOR TWO	BOOKING
NT\$3,000-4,000 (about INR 9,300-12,400) including tour, ordinary extras and meals.	Book 1-3 weeks ahead. Check pickup, language, admission inclusion and cancellation terms.

Vegetarian food

Eat a proper vegetarian breakfast. Jiufen snacks may contain meat broth or animal-derived fillings, so carry a backup snack.

Shopping on this day

Treat Jiufen shopping as incidental. Tea, small crafts and postcards are fine; do not buy heavy or fragile items here.

DECISION NOTE

Jiufen is often marketed as a Spirited Away inspiration, but Studio Ghibli has not officially confirmed that claim.

DAY 4 | WED 4 NOV

LIGHT

Beitou, Tamsui and optional Eslite Nanxi

Overnight: Taipei | Pace: Light

- Take the Red Line and Xinbeitou branch. Walk the library, Hot Spring Museum and Thermal Valley circuit.
- Optional: use a prebooked private hot-spring room. Continue by Red Line to Tamsui for the old street and riverside sunset.
- On the return, optionally stop at Zhongshan MRT for Eslite Spectrum Nanxi before returning to the hotel.

HOW TO MOVE	BAGS
MRT and walking all day. Beitou, Tamsui and Zhongshan sit conveniently on the Red Line.	Leave luggage at the Taipei hotel.
DAY COST FOR TWO	BOOKING
NT\$1,500-2,300 without a bath; add approximately NT\$1,200-3,000 for a private room.	Thermal Valley is walk-up and free. Private bath: 3-7 days ahead. Eslite: walk-in.

Vegetarian food

Use a dedicated vegetarian restaurant rather than relying on Tamsui street snacks; ask about broths and sauces.

Shopping on this day

Eslite Nanxi is excellent for Taiwanese stationery, design objects, books, postcards and compact gifts. Skip it if you want to preserve the light-day pace.

DECISION NOTE

Recheck Thermal Valley's operating hours the day before; it is normally closed Monday.

DAY 5 | THU 5 NOV

ACTIVE

HSR south, theater architecture and optional Rainbow Village

Overnight: Taichung | Pace: Active

- Check out and take an early HSR to Taichung. Transfer at Xinwuri to TRA Taichung and leave bags at a station-area hotel.
- Visit National Taichung Theater. Add Rainbow Village only if arrival is early and the cross-city detour remains comfortable.
- Finish around Calligraphy Greenway, Miyahara or a night market, using a vegetarian restaurant for the main meal.

HOW TO MOVE	BAGS
HSR, local train/MRT and selected short taxi/Uber rides. Taichung is the one city where a few taxis protect limited sightseeing time.	Hotel first. Staying near TRA Taichung simplifies the early Chiayi train tomorrow.
DAY COST FOR TWO	BOOKING
NT\$3,700-4,800 (about INR 11,500-14,900), excluding hotel and shopping.	Reserve HSR when its window opens. Theater public areas, Rainbow Village and local transport are walk-up.

Vegetarian food

EasySuYuan near Taichung Station or BAA Veg Indian Cuisine. Allow NT\$100-600 per person depending on style.

Shopping on this day

Miyahara and theater-area design shops are convenient for compact gift boxes. Check dairy, egg and lard ingredients before purchase.

DECISION NOTE

Rainbow Village is small. Skip it before rushing the theater or creating an expensive cross-city loop.

DAY 6 | FRI 6 NOV

TRANSFER

Full forest railway through Fenqihu

Overnight: Alishan | Pace: Transfer

- Take an early reserved TRA train from Taichung and reach Chiayi TRA by 09:00-09:15.
- Board the 10:00 Alishan mainline. Current pattern: Fenqihu 12:16-13:21, then Alishan arrival 14:56.
- Use the hotel shuttle or walk, check in and take only a short sunset/station-area walk. Save the main forest circuit for tomorrow.

HOW TO MOVE	BAGS
Reserved TRA plus reserved Alishan mainline. This railway is the experience; no private car is needed.	Railway limit: total belongings up to 15 kg per person, with size restrictions. Forward large suitcases Taichung-to-Tainan if needed and take overnight bags.
DAY COST FOR TWO	BOOKING
NT\$3,200-4,300 (about INR 9,900-13,300), excluding hotel.	TRA around its 28-day window. Mainline: 23 Oct at 03:30 IST. Confirm hotel shuttle and vegetarian dinner now.

Vegetarian food

Use the 65-minute Fenqihu stop carefully: buy only a quick vegetarian lunch and carry a backup. Pre-request vegetarian dinner/breakfast at the hotel.

Shopping on this day

Fenqihu offers Alishan tea, railway items, small cypress products and local sweets. Buy compact items only and return to the platform early.

DECISION NOTE

Missing the 10:00 mainline would seriously damage this itinerary. Build at least 40-45 minutes at Chiayi.

DAY 7 | SAT 7 NOV

ACTIVE

Sunrise, cypress forest and Tainan transfer

Overnight: Tainan | Pace: Active

- Optional pre-dawn Zhushan sunrise train. Return for breakfast, check out and leave luggage with the hotel.
- Core circuit: Alishan Station to Zhaoping by branch train; Sister Ponds; Shouzhen Temple; Three Generations Tree; Giant Tree Plank Trails; Sacred Tree Station; train/shuttle back.
- Collect bags, take the targeted 14:40 Route 7329 bus to HSR Chiayi, then HSR to Tainan and taxi/local rail to West Central District.

HOW TO MOVE	BAGS
Sunrise train, branch train, walking, park shuttle, reserved mountain bus and HSR. No taxi inside Alishan.	Hotel stores bags during the forest loop. Keep them with you from Alishan to the Tainan hotel.
DAY COST FOR TWO	BOOKING
NT\$3,200-4,200 (about INR 9,900-13,000), excluding hotel.	Sunrise train: 23 Oct. Bus: reserve 14:40; 16:40 is backup. HSR: book a changeable train after the bus arrival.

Vegetarian food

Hotel breakfast is the safest early meal. Carry snacks; use a known vegetarian restaurant after reaching Tainan.

Shopping on this day

No planned shopping. The day is timing-sensitive and purchases would have to be carried through the forest and transfer.

DECISION NOTE

Sunrise and sea of clouds are weather-dependent. The forest remains worthwhile even in mist or light rain.

DAY 8 | SUN 8 NOV

ACTIVE

Historic Tainan, Hayashi and Anping

Overnight: Tainan | Pace: Active

- Morning: Confucius Temple area, old lanes and Hayashi Department Store.
- After lunch: taxi or bus to Anping Fort and the old settlement. Add Tree House only if it interests you and timing is comfortable.
- Return to West Central for Shennong Street and dinner.

HOW TO MOVE	BAGS
Walk the historic core; use two short taxis or public buses for Anping. No all-day car is needed.	Leave luggage at the Tainan hotel.
DAY COST FOR TWO	BOOKING
NT\$2,400-3,700 (about INR 7,400-11,500), excluding hotel and shopping.	General attractions are walk-up. Hayashi is walk-in. Reserve dinner only for a popular restaurant.

Vegetarian food

Guli Natural Vegan or San Yuan Zhai; verify Sunday hours. Allow NT\$150-450 per person.

Shopping on this day

Hayashi is the best Tainan stop for local design, stationery, ceramics and well-presented food gifts. Allow 45-60 minutes; current hours are 11:00-21:00.

DECISION NOTE

This full day works better on Sunday than Monday because more independent restaurants and attractions should be open.

DAY 9 | MON 9 NOV

ACTIVE

Kaohsiung harbor day and evening HSR north

Overnight: Taipei | Pace: Active

- Check out, take TRA to Xinzuoqing/Zuoying and store luggage in station lockers.
- Use MRT/light rail for Pier-2 outdoor areas, Hamasen and Gushan. Take the public ferry to Cijin.
- Comfortable option: leave Cijin around 16:00 for an 18:00 HSR. Sunset option: book about 19:30 and reach Taipei around 21:30-22:00.

HOW TO MOVE	BAGS
TRA, Kaohsiung MRT/light rail, public ferry and HSR. Store bags at Zuoying so there is no backtracking to Tainan and no Kaohsiung hotel.	Use Zuoying station lockers. Arrive early because large lockers can fill; ask station staff for the backup storage facility.
DAY COST FOR TWO	BOOKING
NT\$4,700-6,000 (about INR 14,600-18,600), excluding hotel and shopping.	HSR Zuoying-Taipei should be reserved. Local rail, metro, light rail, ferry and lockers are walk-up.

Vegetarian food

Hong Jiankang Vegetarian or Little Star Diner in Yancheng; verify Monday hours and keep one backup.

Shopping on this day

Pier-2 design shops are incidental. Final Taipei shopping is possible only with the earlier HSR; do not rely on the late arrival for anything important.

DECISION NOTE

Outdoor Pier-2, Hamasen and Cijin suit Monday. Some indoor museums and independent shops may be closed.

DAY 10 | TUE 10 NOV

LIGHT

Protected departure morning

Overnight: Flight home | Pace: Light

- Breakfast and hotel checkout around 08:30.
- Take Airport MRT Express around 09:00 and aim to reach Taoyuan by 09:40-10:00 for the 13:10 international flight.
- Use airport shopping only for duty-free or a forgotten packaged gift.

HOW TO MOVE	BAGS
Taipei MRT/walking plus Airport MRT Express. Taxi only if rail service or luggage creates a genuine problem.	With you from hotel to airport.
DAY COST FOR TWO	BOOKING
NT\$700-1,200 (about INR 2,200-3,700), excluding booked flight.	Airport MRT is walk-up. Complete airline check-in and confirm terminal the previous evening.

Vegetarian food

Use the hotel area or airport and keep a vegetarian snack for the journey.

Shopping on this day

Airport duty-free and packaged snacks are a backup, not the main shopping plan; selection is narrower and not necessarily cheaper.

DECISION NOTE

Do not add sightseeing. A midday international departure needs a calm airport transfer.

4. Shopping plan

No separate shopping day is needed. These stops are already on the route and cover local gifts, design, beauty and practical purchases without sacrificing major sightseeing.

When	Where	Best for	Recommended time
1 Nov evening	Ximending	Cosmetics, casual fashion, character goods, phone accessories, forgotten essentials	60-120 minutes
2 Nov midday	Dihua Street	Tea, dried fruit/nuts, fabric, bamboo/wood crafts and local packaged gifts	60-90 minutes
2 Nov evening	Xinyi district	Brands, cosmetics, department stores and Taipei 101 gifts	60-120 minutes
4 Nov return	Eslite Spectrum Nanxi	Taiwanese stationery, design objects, books, postcards and compact gifts	60-90 minutes
5 Nov	Miyahara / theater area	Attractive gift boxes and design-shop browsing	30-45 minutes
6 Nov	Fenqihu	Alishan tea, railway items, cypress products and local sweets	Only within the train stop
8 Nov	Hayashi, Tainan	Tainan design, stationery, ceramics and food gifts	45-60 minutes
9 Nov evening	Taipei Main / Ximending	Forgotten items only, if using the earlier HSR	Up to 60 minutes
10 Nov	Taoyuan Airport	Duty-free and emergency packaged gifts	After security

Best three stops

If you are not enthusiastic shoppers, focus only on Dihua Street for tea/local goods, Eslite Nanxi for stationery/design, and Hayashi for Tainan-specific gifts. Ximending is mainly useful for cosmetics and practical purchases.

What is worth buying

- Taiwanese oolong or high-mountain tea from a shop that explains origin and lets you compare products.
- Taiwanese stationery, notebooks, postcards and small design objects.
- Pineapple cakes and shelf-stable pastries, after checking vegetarian ingredients and expiry dates.
- Dried fruit, nuts and mushrooms from a reputable Dihua shop.
- Drugstore cosmetics, masks and sunscreen after comparing with Indian prices.
- Small railway, Alishan or Tainan souvenirs that are meaningful and easy to pack.

What not to assume

International brands and electronics are not automatically cheaper. Check the exact model, tax, voltage and international warranty. Avoid bulky ceramics before Alishan because of the railway luggage limit.

Vegetarian labels

Quan su / chun su generally means vegan. **Dan nai su** means egg-and-dairy vegetarian. **Su shi** means vegetarian. Traditional pastries may contain lard, gelatin or animal-derived seasoning, so ask specifically and check labels.

5. Hotels, luggage and food bases

Planning bands are per room per night for two. Taxes, breakfast and refundable terms vary, so compare the final checkout amount rather than the headline rate.

Base / nights	Recommended hotel/area	Planning band	Why / confirmation
Taipei / 4 + 1	Ximending or Taipei Main CityInn Plus Ximending Alt: Hotel Relax / Orange Hotel Ximen	NT\$2,800-4,200	Airport MRT, HSR and metro access. Booking the same hotel twice reduces navigation friction.
Taichung / 1	Near TRA Taichung 53 Hotel or comparable station hotel	NT\$2,000-3,000	Easy early departure to Chiayi. Confirm luggage forwarding and early checkout.
Alishan / 1	Inside the recreation area Shermuh / Chinshan Villa / Gau Shan	NT\$4,000-6,500	Must be inside the park. Confirm station pickup, heater, breakfast time and vegetarian meal.
Tainan / 2	West Central District U.I.J private room Alt: FX MinSheng / Roots Chew	NT\$3,000-4,500	Best for walking the heritage core, Hayashi and Shennong Street.

Nine-night hotel estimate

Approximately NT\$26,000-39,500, or about INR 81,000-122,000 at the planning rate. The largest uncertainty is the Friday Alishan night.

Luggage workflow

- 1-5 Nov: keep all luggage at the Taipei and Taichung hotels as normal.
- 6 Nov: if suitcases exceed the forest railway allowance, forward large luggage from Taichung to the Tainan hotel and take one-night bags to Alishan.
- 7 Nov: leave overnight bags at the Alishan hotel during the forest walk; collect before the 14:40 bus.
- 9 Nov: travel Tainan to Xinzuoqing with luggage, store it at Zuoying station, sightsee, then collect it for the HSR to Taipei.

Food allowance

Allow roughly NT\$15,000-20,000 for two across the trip (about INR 46,000-62,000). Taipei has many choices; Alishan is the weak point, so request meals in advance and carry backup food. Use dedicated vegetarian restaurants for main meals rather than trusting night-market broths and sauces.

6. Updated ground budget

Flights are already booked, so they are not estimated again. Shopping is personal and shown separately from the trip operating budget.

Category	Couple estimate	Included
Hotels, 9 nights	INR 81,000-122,000	Five Taipei nights, one Taichung, one Alishan, two Tainan.
Intercity + airport transport	INR 26,000-31,000	Airport MRT, HSR, TRA, Alishan mainline and mountain bus.
Local transport	INR 10,000-16,000	Metro, buses, light rail, ferry, lockers and selected taxis.
Tour + admissions	INR 15,000-23,000	North-coast tour, Taipei 101 if used, Alishan branch trains and paid sights.
Vegetarian food	INR 46,000-62,000	Restaurant meals, snacks and higher Alishan food cost.
Insurance, eSIM, laundry, misc.	INR 12,000-20,000	Connectivity, insurance and ordinary contingency.
GROUND TOTAL	INR 190,000-274,000	Add actual booked flights, visa cost if applicable and discretionary shopping.

Comfortable target

Hold approximately INR 2.1-2.4 lakh for ground spending after flights, with an additional reserve. The upper range applies if hotels price high, you take the Taipei 101 observatory and private hot spring, or use more taxis.

Shopping budget

Keep shopping outside the operating budget. A modest gifts/cosmetics allowance of INR 15,000-30,000 for two is workable; tea, ceramics, branded fashion or electronics can raise it quickly.

7. Transport and reservation cheat sheet

Leg / place	Recommended mode	Advance?	Planning cost for two
Taoyuan-Taipei	Airport MRT Express	No	NT\$320 one way
Taipei city	MRT + walking	No	NT\$300-500 per full day
North-coast loop	Shared coach/minibus	Yes, 1-3 weeks	About NT\$3,000-4,000 day total
Taipei-Taichung	HSR reserved seats	Yes	NT\$1,400 standard fare
Taichung city	Transit + selected taxis	No	NT\$1,000-1,500 local movement
Taichung-Chiayi	TRA reserved train	Recommended	Approx. NT\$500-700
Chiayi-Alishan	Forest Railway mainline	Critical	NT\$1,200
Inside Alishan	Branch train + shuttle + walking	Sunrise yes	Approx. NT\$500-900
Alishan-HSR Chiayi	Route 7329 bus	Yes	NT\$566
Chiayi-Tainan	HSR	Yes	NT\$560 standard fare
Tainan-Anping	Walk + bus/two taxis	No	NT\$600-1,000
Tainan-Zuoying	TRA	Usually no	Approx. NT\$200-300
Kaohsiung harbor	MRT + LRT + ferry	No	NT\$300-600
Zuoying-Taipei	HSR reserved seats	Yes	NT\$2,980 standard fare

Movement rule

Every transfer day follows the same principle: hotel or station storage first, bags down, then sightseeing. Kaohsiung is the only no-hotel city, and Zuoying lockers make that stop practical.

8. Weather, clothing and final checks

November clothing

- Taipei and the north coast: mild, sometimes windy or drizzly. Lightweight daytime clothes plus a sweater/light jacket and rain shell cover the variation.
- Tainan and Kaohsiung: warmer. Lightweight clothes are usually appropriate, with one layer for trains and evenings.
- Alishan: substantially colder before sunrise. Pack a fleece or light insulated jacket, long trousers, a rain shell and shoes with grip.
- The forest should be beautiful through evergreen cypress, moss, mist and cloud views. Do not expect cherry blossoms or guaranteed peak red maple color.

Final checklist

Timing	Action
Now	Hotels, visa/TAC, passports, insurance and north-coast tour shortlist.
Early-mid October	HSR/TRA as windows open; luggage forwarding confirmation; restaurant backups.
23 Oct, 03:30 IST	Book 6 Nov mainline and 7 Nov sunrise train; pay immediately.
1 week before	TWAC, eSIM, weather, vegetarian hotel meals, offline confirmations and QR screenshots.
Day before each leg	Recheck platforms, bus/train schedules, closures, weather and hotel shuttles.
9 Nov evening	Confirm return terminal, Airport MRT service and airline check-in status.

Bottom line

This 9-night plan is dense but coherent: four Taipei nights, the north coast, full Alishan mainline plus sunrise option, Tainan heritage, a luggage-safe Kaohsiung day and a protected final Taipei night. Shopping is useful but never allowed to displace the strongest experiences.

9. Official links and planning sources

Use these links to reconfirm the latest timetable, eligibility, operating hours and ticket conditions before payment.

1. [Taiwan Travel Authorization Certificate eligibility](#)
2. [Standard visitor visa requirements](#)
3. [Taiwan Arrival Card](#)
4. [Taiwan HSR booking rules](#)
5. [Taiwan HSR fares](#)
6. [TRA reservation information](#)
7. [Alishan mainline timetable](#)
8. [Alishan online booking rules](#)
9. [Alishan branch-line timetable](#)
10. [Alishan fares](#)
11. [Alishan luggage rules](#)
12. [Alishan Route 7329 timetable](#)
13. [Alishan bus reservation portal](#)
14. [Taipei 101 Observatory tickets](#)
15. [Beitou Thermal Valley](#)
16. [Example Yehliu-Shifen-Jiufen shared tour](#)
17. [TRA station locker service](#)
18. [Dihua Street](#)
19. [Xinyi Shopping District](#)
20. [Eslite Spectrum Nanxi 2026](#)
21. [Hayashi Department Store](#)

Prepared on the basis of confirmed flights and information checked in September 2026. Reconfirm live operating details before payment and travel.